Handbook Q&A Assistant

Project brief: plain-English answers from a company handbook, with citations

Overview

Employees shouldn't have to read a dense 30-page handbook to find a single answer. This tool lets them ask questions in plain English and get instant, cited answers drawn directly from the handbook.

Input

- A single PDF or text file, e.g. **company_handbook.pdf**.

Example questions

> “How many sick leaves do I get?”
>
> “Can I carry forward unused leaves?”
>
> “What is the notice period?”

Before and after

Today	With the assistant
Open a 30-page PDF and skim for the right section	Type a question in plain English
Risk of missing or misreading a clause	Direct answer with a citation to the source passage
Minutes per lookup	Seconds per lookup

Output

- A short, direct answer to the question.
- A **citation** pointing to where in the handbook the answer comes from (section and page).
- If the handbook doesn't cover the question, the assistant says so rather than guessing.

Suggested approach

- **Ingest:** extract text from the PDF or text file, keeping page and section metadata.
- **Chunk:** split into section-sized passages so each answer maps to a citable source.
- **Retrieve:** embed the chunks and find the passages most relevant to the question.
- **Answer:** have an LLM respond using only the retrieved passages, returning citations alongside the answer.

Success criteria

- Answers match what the handbook actually says for the sample questions above.
- Every answer includes a citation the employee can verify.
- Out-of-scope questions are declined clearly instead of invented.